



Documentation Manual

CUSTODY DOCUMENTATION INTELLIGENCE SYSTEM

BUILD v5.3

15 Standard Operating Procedures · 7 AI Prompts · Complete Case Management System
Built by a Registered Nurse with 23 years of documentation experience.

- 1 Foundations — *the principles behind every step*
- 2 Setup — *your system in twenty minutes*
- 3 Something Happened — *ten step-by-step SOPs*
- 4 Maintenance — *weekly review and monthly ritual*
- 5 Court Preparation — *exhibits, binder and go-bag*
- 6 AI Prompt Pack — *and the master checklist*

Documentation uncovers patterns. Patterns reveal truth.

Truth tells the story from facts. An organizational framework, not legal advice. Confirm specifics with your attorney.



What This System Does

DOCUMENTATION INTELLIGENCE FOR HIGH-STAKES SITUATIONS

Court Ready™ is a documentation methodology that helps parents consistently capture, organize and preserve the facts that matter. Each event is documented from the moment it occurs, supported by its related evidence, and linked into a chronological master index.

Over time, individual events become an organized timeline that reveals patterns and provides context. Rather than handing an attorney a collection of scattered documents, you deliver an organized system where events, evidence and reference materials are connected and readily accessible.

THE ONE RULE

Document what a camera would see.

Times. Dates. Direct quotes. Observable actions. Nothing else.

What documentation intelligence means

Collecting, organizing, indexing and analyzing records so they become meaningful and defensible. The system transforms isolated records into organized intelligence — simple enough to follow with limited technical experience, structured enough for a legal professional to navigate in minutes.

About the author

I am a Registered Nurse with 23 years of experience creating and implementing practical documentation systems in high-stakes healthcare settings. I began in hospital care, advanced to Director of Nursing at two facilities, and built my own company of four residential group homes with a full nursing department, guiding it through CARF accreditation.

WHY THIS SYSTEM EXISTS

I went through two custody proceedings without adequate documentation support. This system is what I wish I'd had.

IMPORTANT

Court Ready™ does not provide legal advice or determine the outcome of a case. It provides a structured framework so you can present the most complete, organized and factually supported record possible to your legal representative.

What's in Your Download

EVERY COMPONENT AND WHAT IT DOES FOR YOU

Calendar.html

Your daily entry point. Opens in any browser. Set your custody schedule, mark deviations, track appointments. This is the first thing you open every day.

Court Ready Master Index

The chronological index of your entire case. One lean row per event, linked to its Case Management File. The Dashboard shows your documentation coverage at a glance. A filled-in sample copy is included for reference.

Case Record Form

The form you fill out when something happens. Mostly checkboxes. Three short writing blocks for significant events: Context, Event, Outcome. Its built-in Evidence section holds one exhibit card per piece of evidence — each card records what the evidence shows, when it was captured, and generates its court-ready file name.

Reference Library

Six named folders for documents that span your entire case: court orders, medical records, school records, parenting plan, attorney files and contacts.

Case Management File folder

Where each event lives. Every event gets its own subfolder containing the Case Record Form and its exhibits.

Prompts folder

Seven AI prompts as standalone text files. Copy, paste into any AI assistant, receive entries formatted for your Case Record Form.

Quick Start Checklist

A three-page printable with the setup steps, the Evidence Collection Checklist and a scanner guide for your phone.

This manual

Standard operating procedures for every situation you will encounter.

START HERE

You do not need to read this manual cover to cover before you begin. Read Part 1, do Part 2, then come back to Part 3 the first time something happens.



The Camera Rule

THE SINGLE PRINCIPLE BEHIND EVERY STEP

Before you document a single event, you need one rule: **document what a camera would see**. Not what you feel. Not what you think. Not what you believe the other parent is doing. Only what a camera placed in the room would have recorded.

This is how nurses chart. A nurse does not write "patient seems like they don't care about getting better." A nurse writes "patient refused medication at 2:15 PM. Stated: 'I don't want it.' Physician notified at 2:20 PM." Facts. Times. Direct quotes. Observable behavior. That is what your documentation needs to look like.

The same moment, written twice

FEELING

He was late AGAIN because he doesn't care about the kids.

FACT

Scheduled exchange 5:00 PM. Parent B arrived 5:47 PM. No advance notice. Third late arrival in 30 days.

FEELING

She screamed at me like a lunatic in front of Emma.

FACT

At the 5:00 PM exchange, Parent B raised her voice and said "you'll regret this" while Emma stood beside Parent A.

FEELING

Jack came home a mess — obviously neglected.

FACT

Jack returned in Friday's clothes. He stated he had not bathed. His inhaler was not returned.

TIP

Your feelings tell you *what* to document. They just don't go *in* the entry. Feel the anger, then write the facts.

Parent A and Parent B

All documentation uses Parent A (you) and Parent B (the other parent). This keeps every entry neutral.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Notice the second example: Parent A admitting their own lateness is what makes the whole record believable. A record that only ever favors you reads as advocacy. A record that includes your own misses reads as truth.



The Three-Block Narrative

CONTEXT, EVENT, OUTCOME — EVERY SINGLE TIME

When something significant happens, your Case Record Form captures it in three blocks. This structure comes from clinical documentation — it is how nurses chart assessments. Most events only need checkboxes. The three blocks are for when detail matters.

- 1 Block 1 — Event leading to the incident.** What was scheduled or expected? What was the context before the event occurred? This establishes the baseline: what should have happened.
Example: Visitation exchange scheduled for 5:00 PM at Parent A's residence per court order. Parent A arrived at 5:10 PM.
- 2 Block 2 — Description of event.** What happened, in order? Include exact times, direct quotes and what you personally observed. No interpretation.
Example: Parent A was 10 minutes late. Parent B stated: "I am very upset that you're 10 minutes late." Parent A acknowledged the delay. Children transferred at 5:12 PM.
- 3 Block 3 — Immediate outcome and impact.** What happened right after? How was it resolved? What was the child's visible state?
Example: Child was visibly upset during exchange. Parent A drove home. No further communication between parties. Evening continued with normal routine.

TIP

Routine events — a calm exchange, a normal day — only need checkboxes. Save the three blocks for significant events. But do log the routine. It proves your baseline.

The naming convention

Every file. Every time. No exceptions.

YYYY-MM-DD_Type_Description



Factor Tags

EIGHT TAGS YOUR DASHBOARD COUNTS AUTOMATICALLY

Every event gets tagged with the factor it supports. Your Dashboard counts these automatically and shows you where your record is strong and where it is thin.

ST

Stability & Routine

PI

Parental Involvement

HS

Health & Safety

CC

Co-Parenting Conduct

EW

Emotional Wellbeing

ED

Education

FS

Financial Support

PF

Parental Fitness

NOTE

Factors vary by state. Confirm yours with your attorney. These are organizational tags, not legal conclusions.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Tagging turns a pile of events into an argument. When your Dashboard shows four entries under Health & Safety and none under Education, you know exactly what to document next — before someone else notices the gap for you.



SOP 0 • Setting Up Your System

DO THIS ONCE, IN TWENTY MINUTES, THEN YOU ARE READY

- 1 **Unzip your download.** You should see the 00_START_HERE folder and four numbered folders: 01_Case_Management_File, 02_Reference_Library, 03_Exhibit_Production, 04_Backups.
- 2 **Choose your template format.** The Case Record Form comes in HTML and PDF. HTML opens in your browser with interactive dropdowns and auto-generated file names. PDF is a traditional fillable form. Pick one and use it every time.
- 3 **Open Calendar.html** in your browser. Click Custody Schedule Setup. Toggle each day between "Mine" and "Theirs" to match your arrangement. Enter your exchange time and location. Select your schedule source. Click Save.
- 4 **Open the Master Index.** Go to the Lists & Setup tab and review the dropdown options. Everything here flows to every other tab automatically.
- 5 **Open the sample index.** Browse the Event Index to see how lean rows link to event folders. Open the Dashboard to see how factor coverage looks with data. This is your reference — do not edit it.
- 6 **Set up your Reference Library.** Place existing court orders, your parenting plan, medical records, school records, attorney documents and contacts in their named folders. These are baseline documents that span your whole case.
- 7 **Read the Quick Start Checklist.** Page 1 is your setup checklist. Page 2 is the Evidence Collection Checklist. Page 3 teaches you to scan documents with your phone.
- 8 **You're ready.** When something happens, go to Part 3.

TIP

Save a backup copy of your Master Index immediately after setup. Name it with today's date. Keep the original untouched.



Communication & Exchanges

A TEXT ARRIVES, AN EXCHANGE OCCURS — DO THIS

SOP 1

A Text Message Arrives

When this happens: *you receive a text from Parent B about the children, the schedule, or anything case-related.*

- 1 Screenshot the **entire thread** — scroll up to capture the full context, not just the latest message. Make sure the contact name, date and time are visible.
- 2 Save it using the naming convention: `2026-07-16_Text_ScheduleChange.png`
- 3 Open your Case Record Form. Check "Communication" as the event type. Fill in date, time, parties. Routine? Checkboxes are enough. Significant? Write the three blocks.
- 4 In the Evidence section, add an exhibit card for the screenshot. The card generates the court-ready file name — rename your screenshot to match.
- 5 Create the Case Management File: `EVT-0015_2026-07-16_Communication` . Place the form inside, with an Exhibits subfolder for the screenshot.
- 6 Open the Master Index. Paste a lean row into the Event Index.

DO NOT

Crop the screenshot to show only the good parts. A cropped screenshot invites the question: what aren't we seeing?

When this happens: *it's exchange day — whether it goes well or not.*

- 1 Open your Calendar. Note whether the exchange was on time, late or missed. Mark any deviation with details.
- 2 Open the Case Record Form. Check "Exchange." Fill in time, location and parties present.
- 3 If anything notable happened, capture the evidence and add an exhibit card for it.
- 4 Create the Case Management File. Place the form and any exhibits inside.
- 5 Paste the lean row into your Master Index.
- 6 If the exchange was completely normal and calm, **still log it**. Mark it routine.

WHY THIS MATTERS

A record that only captures problems looks like a grudge. A record that captures everything — including calm, on-time handoffs — looks like the truth.



Concerns & School Records

A CHILD RETURNS HURT, THE SCHOOL SENDS WORD

SOP 3

Child Returns with an Injury or Concern

When this happens: *your child comes home with an injury, illness, emotional distress or missing belongings.*

- 1 Photograph the injury or condition immediately. Clear, well-lit, showing context.
- 2 Name the photo: `2026-07-16_Photo_BruiseLeftArm.jpg` — do not leave it in your camera roll.
- 3 If medical attention is needed, seek it. Save the visit summary and any prescriptions. These are third-party records that independently verify your documentation.
- 4 Open the Case Record Form. Check "Incident" and/or "Medical." Write the three blocks: what was expected, what you observed, what you did about it.
- 5 Note in Block 2 whether you notified Parent B, when and how. This builds co-parenting conduct evidence.
- 6 Add an exhibit card for every piece of evidence, then paste the lean row into your Master Index.

DO NOT

Interrogate your child about what happened at the other parent's house. Document what you observe, not what you investigate.

When this happens: *you receive an email, note, report card, attendance record or conference request.*

- 1 Save it as a PDF: `2026-07-16_School_AttendanceReport.pdf`
- 2 Open the Case Record Form. Check "School." Note the school contact name and topic.
- 3 In Block 2, note whether you forwarded it to Parent B. If it was a conference, note who attended.
- 4 Add an exhibit card for it, place everything in the Case Management File, paste the lean row.

TIP

School records are some of your strongest evidence because they come from a neutral third party. Request attendance printouts, report cards and conference summaries proactively — don't wait for them to arrive.



Medical Visits & Joint Decisions

AN APPOINTMENT HAPPENS, A DECISION NEEDS BOTH PARENTS

SOP 5

A Medical Appointment Happens

When this happens: *a doctor visit, dental appointment, therapy session or urgent care visit.*

- 1 Attend the appointment. Ask for a visit summary or discharge papers before you leave.
- 2 Name the document: `2026-07-16_Medical_AsthmaPatel.pdf`
- 3 Open the Case Record Form. Check "Medical." Include provider name, reason, outcome and instructions.
- 4 In Block 2, document whether you notified Parent B about the appointment — before and after — when and how.
- 5 Add an exhibit card, place everything in the Case Management File, paste the lean row.
- 6 Add any copay or cost to the Expense Summary tab.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Medical documents prove Health & Safety *and* Parental Involvement at the same time. Every appointment you attend and document counts twice.

When this happens: *camp enrollment, school choice, sports signup, medical treatment — anything requiring input from both parents.*

- 1 Send your proposal to Parent B **in writing**. Include what, when, cost and a deadline for response. Save the communication.
- 2 If Parent B responds, save the response. If Parent B does not respond by the deadline, **that non-response is the documentation**.
- 3 Open the Case Record Form. Check "Decision." Block 1: what was needed and when you proposed it. Block 2: response or silence. Block 3: what was decided and by whom.
- 4 Create the Case Management File with the proposal, any response and related receipts.
- 5 Paste the lean row into your Master Index.

TIP

A pattern of unanswered proposals is powerful co-parenting evidence. Document every proposal with the date sent and the deadline given, then document the response or the silence.



Expenses & Phone Calls

MONEY LEAVES YOUR ACCOUNT, A CALL TAKES PLACE

SOP 7

A Child-Related Expense Occurs

When this happens: *you pay for something related to the children — copay, school supplies, clothing, activities, childcare.*

- 1 Keep the receipt. Photograph it immediately: `2026-07-16_Receipt_CampEnrollment.jpg`
- 2 Open the Case Record Form. Check "Expense." Include the amount, what it was for and which child.
- 3 Add an exhibit card for the receipt.
- 4 Paste the lean row into the Event Index **and** add the details to the Expense Summary tab.
- 5 If you are requesting reimbursement from Parent B, note when and how you requested it.

DO NOT

Throw away receipts. Photograph them the same day, name them, file them. Every dollar is documented.

When this happens: *you have a phone conversation with Parent B about the children.*

- 1 Immediately after the call ends, open the Case Record Form. Check "Communication." Fill in date, time and approximate duration.
- 2 Write the three blocks from memory while the conversation is fresh. Use direct quotes where you remember them.
- 3 If you took notes during the call, save them. If not, your Case Record Form **is** the contemporaneous note — it was written immediately after.
- 4 Create the Case Management File. Paste the lean row into your Master Index.
- 5 If the call produced an agreement, follow up with a confirming text: "Just confirming what we discussed — I'll take Tuesday transport, you'll take Thursday." Screenshot that confirmation.

TIP

A confirming text after a phone call is one of the most powerful habits you can build. It creates a written record of a verbal conversation and gives Parent B a fair chance to correct any misunderstanding.



Anger & Schedule Changes

YOU WANT TO RESPOND, THE SCHEDULE SHIFTS

SOP 9

You're Angry and Need to Respond

When this happens: *something has made you furious, hurt or overwhelmed — and you want to fire off a response.*

- 1 **Stop.** Do not send anything to Parent B yet.
- 2 Open a blank document or notes app. Write everything you want to say. All of it. Every feeling. Get it out.
- 3 Save it as `2026-07-16_Private_Vent_Letter.pdf` in a private location — never in your shared Court Ready folder, never anywhere Parent B could access.
- 4 Wait at least 30 minutes. Then open AI Prompt 1 and add its "from emotional venting" option line. Paste your vent. The AI strips every emotion and returns only the facts.
- 5 Open the Case Record Form. Use the output to fill the three blocks with clean, neutral facts.
- 6 If you need to reply to Parent B, write a brief, factual response.

DO NOT

Send the emotional version. Ever. One angry text can undermine months of careful documentation.

WHY THIS MATTERS

The unsent version becomes a private record. The clean version goes on the record. Your credibility stays intact.

When this happens: *Parent B is late, a visit is missed, the schedule is altered without agreement, or a makeup day is requested.*

- 1 Open your Calendar. Click the day. Check "Mark as Deviation." Fill in what was scheduled versus what happened, who initiated it, and whether it was agreed.
- 2 Open the Case Record Form. Check "Exchange." Write the three blocks with exact times.
- 3 If there's evidence — a text saying they'll be late, or no communication at all — capture it and add an exhibit card.
- 4 Create the Case Management File and paste the lean row into your Master Index.
- 5 Add the deviation to the Custody Schedule tab's Deviation Log with the Event ID.

TIP

Over time the Calendar's deviation markers tell a visual story. Twelve months of printed Calendar views showing a pattern of late arrivals is evidence a judge can see at a glance.



Keeping the System Healthy

FIFTEEN MINUTES ON SUNDAY, FIFTEEN ON THE FIRST

SOP 11

Sunday Evening Review

When this happens: *every Sunday evening. Fifteen minutes. Non-negotiable.*

- 1 Open your Calendar. Review the week. Anything undocumented? Create the Case Record Form now and note: "Recalled on [today] re: [date of event]."
- 2 Open your Dashboard. Check factor coverage. Any factor showing thin or blind spot? Plan what to document this week to fill it.
- 3 Check that every Case Management File from this week is complete: form saved as PDF, exhibits named to match their cards, lean row in the Master Index.
- 4 Verify no original evidence files have been altered. If you annotated anything, confirm you worked on a copy.

TIP

Sunday reviews catch gaps before they become permanent. A missing form from Tuesday is easy to create on Sunday. A missing form from six months ago is unreliable.

SOP 12

Monthly Ritual

When this happens: *the first of the month. Fifteen minutes. Backup and review.*

- ☐ Export last month's text threads and app messages to PDF. Name them by convention.
- ☐ Create a dated backup of your entire Court Ready folder.
- ☐ Print the Calendar's monthly view. File it in your binder or Reference Library.
- ☐ Open the Dashboard. Review factor coverage. Plan entries for thin areas.
- ☐ Confirm your cloud backup synced successfully.
- ☐ Archive completed events older than six months if your folder is getting large.



Exhibits & Your Binder

TURN YOUR RECORD INTO SOMETHING HANDED ACROSS A TABLE

SOP 13

Preparing Your Exhibits

When this happens: *your attorney needs your documentation, or a hearing is coming.*

- 1 Open the Exhibit Index tab. This shows every event you marked exhibit-worthy. Sort by Primary Factor.
- 2 Review each description. Use AI Prompt 4 to polish them into professional one-line summaries.
- 3 For each exhibit, verify the Case Management File is complete and every evidence file is named to match its card.
- 4 Mark each exhibit's status: Ready, In Progress or Filed.
- 5 Print the Exhibit Index. This becomes your binder's table of contents.

DO NOT

Send the Attorney Communication Log. It is privileged. It never leaves your Attorney Documents folder and never goes in a binder.

When this happens: *your exhibits are ready. Now make them presentable.*

- 1 **Table of contents** — your printed Exhibit Index, sorted by factor.
- 2 **Court documents** — current orders, petitions, hearing notices, newest first.
- 3 **Opening notes** — one page: two or three points you must make, each with Event IDs.
- 4 **Evidence by factor** — tabbed sections matching the Dashboard, forms and exhibits inside each.
- 5 **Witnesses** — printed Witness List plus any attorney-approved statements.
- 6 **Closing notes** — one page: what you're asking the court for, tied to factors.

TIP

Three copies of everything: one for the court, one for the other party, one for you. Never surrender your only copy. Originals stay in your Court Ready folder.



SOP 15 · The Court-Day Go-Bag

PACKED THE NIGHT BEFORE, CALM BY DESIGN

DOCUMENTS

- ☐ Binder — all three copies
- ☐ Extra Exhibit Index printouts
- ☐ Certified copy of current orders
- ☐ Photo ID
- ☐ Legal pad and two pens
- ☐ Calendar monthly printouts

YOURSELF

- ☐ Professional outfit — laid out tonight
- ☐ Water and a protein snack
- ☐ Phone off before the courtroom door
- ☐ Tissues
- ☐ Daily medications
- ☐ Support person confirmed

LOGISTICS

- ☐ Courthouse address and courtroom number
- ☐ Parking plan plus a backup plan
- ☐ Arrive 45 minutes early
- ☐ Childcare confirmed plus backup
- ☐ Work notified, full day blocked
- ☐ Attorney's cell number on paper

THE NIGHT BEFORE

- ☐ Gas tank filled
- ☐ Two alarms set
- ☐ Outfit hanging
- ☐ Go-bag by the door

THEN CLOSE THE BINDER AND REST

**You didn't just tell your story.
You proved it.**

AI Prompt Pack

SEVEN PROMPTS, ALSO SAVED IN YOUR PROMPTS FOLDER

These prompts work with ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini or any AI assistant. Each is also saved as a standalone text file for easy copy-paste. Always paste the Master System Prompt first when starting a new conversation.

MASTER SYSTEM PROMPT — PASTE FIRST, EVERY CONVERSATION

You are a documentation assistant for Court Ready. Use neutral, fact-only language. Use Parent A and Parent B. Never fabricate details. Flag missing information as [NEEDS: date]. Structure output in three blocks: Context, Event, Outcome.

- 1 **Complete Case Record** — converts raw notes into a full three-block entry with tags. Includes option lines for medical, school and expense events, journal notes, and emotional venting.
- 2 **Single Block** — rewrites just Block 1, 2 or 3 from raw notes.
- 3 **Evidence Context Notes** — writes two context lines for an exhibit card: what the evidence shows and why it matters.
- 4 **Exhibit Index Description** — creates a professional one-line exhibit description with factor tag.
- 5 **Co-Parenting Pattern Summary** — reviews multiple events and summarizes patterns in neutral language.
- 6 **Monthly Review** — reviews recent events, suggests additions, identifies thin factors.

TIP

Specialized needs from earlier editions — medical, school, expense, journal, vent — are now option lines inside Prompt 1. Nothing was removed.

Master Documentation Checklist

PRINT THIS PAGE AND TAPE IT TO THE WALL

WHEN SOMETHING HAPPENS

- ☐ Capture evidence immediately.
- ☐ Name the file: YYYY-MM-DD_Type_Description.
- ☐ Open the Case Record Form. Check boxes. Three blocks if significant.
- ☐ Add an exhibit card for each piece of evidence.
- ☐ Create the Case Management File: EVT-####_Date_Type.
- ☐ Place the form and exhibits in the folder.
- ☐ Paste the lean row into the Event Index.
- ☐ Mark the Calendar if deviation or appointment.

SUNDAY EVENING · 15 MINUTES

- ☐ Review Calendar — anything undocumented?
- ☐ Check Dashboard factor coverage.
- ☐ Verify Case Management Files are complete.
- ☐ Confirm no originals were altered.

MONTHLY RITUAL · FIRST OF THE MONTH

- ☐ Export texts and messages to PDF.
- ☐ Backup entire folder with today's date.
- ☐ Print Calendar monthly view.
- ☐ Review Dashboard, fill thin factor areas.
- ☐ Confirm cloud backup synced.

COURT PREPARATION

- ☐ Review Exhibit Index by factor.
- ☐ Polish descriptions with AI Prompt 4.
- ☐ Assemble binder: three copies, SOP 14 order.
- ☐ Confirm Attorney Log stays private.
- ☐ Pack the go-bag the night before.

Disclaimer — The Court Ready™ Custody Documentation System is an organizational and record-management tool inspired by clinical documentation principles. It does not provide legal advice, legal strategy or legal representation. Laws, evidentiary rules and custody standards vary by jurisdiction. Consult a licensed attorney. Users are solely responsible for ensuring documentation is truthful, authentic, lawfully obtained and compliant with applicable laws. Never create, alter, embellish or misrepresent evidence.